



CTI GROUP WORLDWIDE SERVICES, INC.

CTI GROUP WORLDWIDE SERVICES

CULTURAL EXCHANGE PROGRAM

POLICIES



CTI GROUP WORLDWIDE SERVICES, INC.

CTI GROUP WORLDWIDE SERVICES CULTURAL EXCHANGE PROGRAM – POLICIES

Stage 1

1. **Participant Assessment:** In Stage One, our recruiters will assess your skills, resume, and capabilities, and evaluate your background. This process is conducted at no cost to you.
2. **Participant Assessment Approval:** If we believe you possess the qualifications and background required by our host organization, we will proceed to the next phase. At this point, a fee of \$150 (one hundred and fifty dollars) is charged to initiate document preparation, guidance, and other necessary steps under the cultural exchange program.
3. **Participant Preparation for Interview:** To ensure you present the best aspects of your experience and increase your chances of approval, our team will:
 - Review and update your resume as needed.
 - Collect additional documents.
 - Provide guidance about the cultural exchange program you will be joining.
 - Walk you through the job description to ensure full understanding.
 - Conduct mock interviews, if necessary, to equip you with all the tools needed for success.
4. **Participant Interview Scheduling:** CTI Group will schedule your interview with the hosting company upon completion of the required documents and background checks.

Participant Host Company Interview Attendance Guidelines:

- **Punctuality:** You must be ready at least 15 minutes before the scheduled interview time, with your computer and equipment prepared.



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- **Technical Requirements:** Ensure your microphone is working and you have a stable internet connection.
 - **Environment:** Be in a quiet setting with a clean background, free from disturbances or people moving around.
 - **No-Show Policy:** If you fail to attend the scheduled interview without prior notice, affecting CTI Group's reputation with the host company, you will be required to pay \$100 (one hundred dollars) to return to the program at Phase
 - **Participant Interview Scheduling:** In case of a medical issue or emergency, you must inform CTI Group at least 72 hours in advance to avoid penalties.
 - **Post-Interview:** Upon approval in the interview, the hosting company will provide you with the cultural exchange contract letter.
5. **Participant Fails the Interview:** We endorse participants for interviews because we strongly believe their profiles match the host company's requirements. If you do not pass the interview, CTI Group will find another hosting company to provide you with a new opportunity to showcase your skills and personality. This will be arranged at no additional cost to you.
6. **Participant is Approved:** Once you are approved by the host company, it's time to prepare for Stage 2.
7. **Transition to Stage 2:** To enter the second stage, a fee of \$1,450 (one thousand four hundred and fifty dollars) is charged. You will have between 0 to 18 months to transition from Stage 1 to Stage 2. This timeframe will be provided by CTI Group in a written and signed letter based on your specific situation and the agreement between you and CTI Group. If the participant is offered a position, and they decline, this fee will not be refunded. If the participant cancels after accepting the offer, this fee will not be refunded.

Examples:

1. **Missing Documents:** If only a simple document is missing, CTI Group may grant up to 6 months for you to obtain it.
2. **Educational Requirements:** If you need to complete a certain minimum period of enrollment in a university, CTI Group may adjust the timeframe based on the period needed within the 18-month window.



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3. **Experience Requirements:** If you need to acquire a certain amount of experience, CTI Group may adjust the timeframe based on your needs, adhering to the 18-month limit.
8. **Refund Policy:** If you decide to withdraw from the program, no refund will be provided. As mentioned in Clause 7, CTI Group may offer a written letter granting up to 18 months under Stage 1 based on your needs or specific situation. However, after 18 months, the process will be archived, and you will need to start over.

Stage 2

1. **CTI Files Application to Sponsor:** At this phase, CTI Group will review and submit all documents required by the sponsor. The participant must cooperate and maintain communication with the CTI Group team to ensure all documents are accurate and meet the sponsor's requirements.
2. **Participant Sponsor Interview Preparation:** The CTI Group team will provide videos or conduct a personal walkthrough of important points to align you with the sponsor's standards and expectations. CTI Group will schedule an interview with the sponsor and ensure all your information is submitted on the sponsor's platform.
3. **Participant Sponsor Interview Attendance:**
 - **Punctuality:** You must be ready at least 15 minutes before the scheduled interview time, with your computer and equipment prepared.
 - **Technical Requirements:** Ensure your microphone is working, you have a stable internet connection, and you are in a quiet environment conducive to a successful interview.
 - **Environment:** Make sure your background is clean and free from distractions, with no people moving around during the interview.

Upon approval in the interview, the sponsor will provide you with the cultural exchange sponsorship program details. If you fail to attend the scheduled interview without prior notice, harming CTI Group's reputation with the sponsor, you will be required to pay a penalty



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of \$100 (one hundred dollars) to return to the program at Phase 3: Participant Sponsor Interview Attendance. In case of a medical issue or an emergency, you must inform CTI Group at least 72 hours in advance to avoid penalties.

4. **Participant Fails the Sponsor Interview:** If you do not pass the interview, CTI Group will find another sponsor to provide you with a new opportunity to showcase your skills and personality. This will be arranged at no additional cost to you.
5. **Participant is Approved:** Once you are approved by the sponsor, it's time to prepare for Stage 3. The sponsorship fee of \$2,493 (Two thousand four hundred ninety-three dollars) will be collected at this point.
6. **Transition to Stage 3:** To enter the third stage, a fee of \$857 (eight hundred fifty-seven dollars) is charged. You will have 30 days to transition from Stage 2 to Stage 3. To avail of this 30-day period, you must have already completed the payment of the sponsorship fee. CTI Group will provide you with a written and signed letter specifying the timeframe based on your specific situation and the agreement between you and CTI Group.

Examples:

1. **Completing Payment of \$857:** If you only need to complete the payment of \$857, CTI Group may grant a period of 30 days.
2. **Completing Sponsorship Fee of \$2,493:** If you need to complete the sponsorship fee of \$2,493, CTI Group may issue a letter allowing 15 days, as we need to pay the sponsor promptly to set up the visa interview process after your approval in the sponsor interview.
3. **Additional Time Needed:** If you require more time to raise the necessary funds, the CTI Group Manager will assess your situation and, based on the sponsor's policies, find the best solution. In all cases, CTI Group will provide a written letter outlining the time available, keeping in mind the need to meet the hosting company's schedule and the sponsor's agenda.

7. Refund Policy



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If you decide to withdraw from the program, no money will be refunded for any payments made in **Stage 1 and Stage 2**. However, if you have already paid the **\$2,493 sponsorship fee**, a **partial refund** will be processed after deducting the following amounts:

- **Sponsor Cancellation Fee:** \$1,000
- **SEVIS Fee:** \$220
- **Visa Application Fee:** \$185 (non-refundable)

After these deductions, the **remaining balance** from the **\$2,493 sponsorship fee** will be refunded to you.

Procedures:

1. **Formal Withdrawal Letter:** You must submit a formal letter stating your intent to withdraw from the cultural exchange program.
2. **Placing the Process on Hold:** If you wish to put your process on hold, you must pay the **\$1,000 sponsor cancellation fee**. CTI Group will issue a letter specifying the time requested by you, not exceeding **18 months** from the application submission date.
3. **Resuming the Process:** When you decide to resume after placing the process on hold, you must **redo the interview** with the hosting company and undergo **another interview with the sponsor**. There will be no additional cost from CTI Group, provided this occurs within the **18-month timeframe**.

Stage 3

1. **Participant Visa Preparation:** You will receive orientation from CTI Group on how to conduct yourself during the visa interviews. The CTI Group team will revisit all services provided under the cultural exchange program. You will receive detailed information about your destination in the USA, the duration of your stay, and the company you will be joining under the cultural exchange visa. All necessary information will be clarified prior to your visa interview.



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2. **CTI Group Mock Visa Interview:** The CTI Group team will conduct a mock interview to better prepare you for the upcoming visa interview.
3. **Document Review:** The CTI Group team will review all required documents once more and coordinate with the sponsor and hosting company to ensure accuracy.
4. **Participant Visa Interview Attendance:**
 - **Punctuality:** You must arrive at least 45 minutes before the scheduled interview time to ensure timely attendance.
 - **Professional Appearance:** Be well-groomed and present yourself professionally for the interview.
 - **Honesty:** Never lie or withhold any requested information during the interview.
 - **Required Documents:** Bring all necessary documents to the embassy; having everything needed is crucial for a successful interview.

Upon approval in the interview, the embassy (immigration) will provide you with the cultural exchange J-1 Visa. If you fail to attend the scheduled interview without prior notice, you will be required to pay a penalty of \$100 (one hundred dollars) to return to the program at Phase 4: Participant Visa Interview Attendance. In case of a medical issue or an emergency, you must inform CTI Group at least 72 hours in advance to avoid penalties.

5. **Participant Fails the Visa Interview:** If you do not pass the visa interview, CTI Group will obtain feedback from the sponsor and provide another opportunity for you, following embassy procedures and policies regarding the suitable time to reapply. This will be arranged at no additional cost to you.
6. **Participant is Approved:** Once you are approved by the embassy, it's time to prepare for Stage 4. To enter Stage 4, a fee of \$857 (eight hundred fifty-seven dollars). CTI Group has divided the process into four stages to make it easier for participants to fulfill the payments based on the completion of tasks and required documents at each stage.
7. **Additional Fee for Trainee Participants:** For applicants under the **Trainee category** (not Internship), an additional fee of **\$275 (two hundred seventy-five dollars)** will be collected at Stage 3. This fee applies exclusively to Trainee participants and does not apply to Internship participants.



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8. **Fee Breakdown:** It's important for you to understand the costs of the visa and the associated fees. Below is a breakdown of the amounts paid at this stage for clarification:
- **CTI Group Cultural Exchange Program and Sponsor Fee:** \$4,545
 - **Visa Fee:** \$185.00
 - **SEVIS Fee:** \$220.00
 - **Total:** \$4,950.00
9. **Refund Policy:** If you decide to withdraw from the program, no money will be refunded. However, if you have already paid the sponsor fee, a deduction of \$1,000 (One thousand dollars) will be made to cover the sponsor's cancellation fee, and the remaining balance intended for the sponsor will be refunded to you.
- **Penalty Deduction:** From the \$2,493 sponsor fee, an amount of \$1,000 will be taken as a penalty to cover the sponsor's cancellation fee.

Procedures:

1. **Formal Withdrawal Letter:** You must write a formal letter stating your desire to withdraw from the cultural exchange program.
2. **Placing the Process on Hold:** If you wish to put your process on hold, you must pay the \$1,000 fee, which will be sent to the sponsor. CTI Group will issue a letter specifying the time requested by you, not exceeding 18 months from the application submission date.
3. **Resuming the Process:** When you decide to resume after placing the process on hold, you must redo the interview with the hosting company, undergo another interview with the sponsor, and attend another visa interview. There will be no additional cost from CTI Group, provided this occurs within the 18-month timeframe.



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Stage 4

1. **Participant Assignment Date Coordination:** At this stage, CTI Group will coordinate your assignment date with the hosting company and ensure alignment with the sponsor.

Policy on Program Start Date Changes: In the event that a participant needs to change the program start date due to visa refusal or personal circumstances, the sponsor will conduct a case review and seek approval from the host organization. Approval is contingent upon the availability of new dates and logistical feasibility. If approved, the sponsor will be issuing a new DS-2019 form and updating the DS-7002 Training Plan accordingly. This process will incur administrative fees as follows: **first date change:** \$150 (one hundred fifty dollars), **second date change:** \$250 (two hundred fifty dollars), **third date change:** \$350 (three hundred fifty dollars).

2. **CTI Group Logistics:** To arrange flights and coordinate with the hosting company for your airport pickup and accommodation during your stay in the USA, CTI Group will follow up with you to ensure the following items are addressed promptly to match the assignment dates arranged by the sponsor and hosting company.
 - o **Airline Tickets:** You may need to purchase a round-trip ticket upfront based on the sponsor's requirements. Please check if this applies to you and follow up with CTI Group through a written letter or email for the best options available for your cultural exchange program. **You are responsible for paying for your airline tickets.**
 - o **Accommodation:** In certain circumstances, your hosting company may cover accommodation; however, this is an exception. Most of the time, you will be responsible for your accommodation expenses. Prices may vary, but the hosting company will arrange where you will stay. You will need to provide a down payment, usually the first and last month's rent upfront. This is common practice in the USA, where tenants pay the first and second month's rent in advance. **Typically, dorms for J1 participants range from \$800 to \$1,200 per month; therefore, the upfront payment you must present to CTI Group to coordinate with the hosting company ranges from \$800 to \$1,200.**



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- **Travel Funds:** CTI Group recommends that you travel with at least \$300 (three hundred dollars) for personal expenses.
- 3. **Pre-Departure Seminar:** CTI Group will hold a pre-departure seminar or webinar to answer any questions you may have and share contact information for the hosting company to facilitate your pick up at the airport. During this seminar, we encourage you to ask questions and clarify any subjects to ensure a smooth departure and arrival in the USA. We also encourage you to research U.S. laws and regulations, which may differ from those in your country, to avoid any issues.
- 4. **Support During Your Stay in the USA:** During your stay in the USA, the CTI Group team will periodically check in with you to ensure everything is running smoothly. If you need any support, we are ready to help and guide you, following U.S. laws and the instructions provided by our sponsors and hosting companies.
 - **Returning to Your Country:** To ensure future opportunities remain open to you, we encourage you to return to your country at the end of your contract with the hosting organization. If you have any questions, the CTI Group team is ready to support and assist you. **Do not overstay your visa in the USA.**
- 5. **Medical Emergencies:** If you experience any medical emergency at any time, please contact your hosting company (employer) and inform us immediately. We will work with the sponsor to support you as needed and ensure that all necessary procedures are followed.

Payments From 50% to 100% in Advance

Participants have the flexibility to pay 50% to 100% of the full program cost of \$4,950 at any stage of the process. Below are the policies governing these payments:

Advance Payments at Stage 1:

- Participants may choose to pay 50% (\$2,475) or 100% (\$4,950) of the program cost while still in Stage 1.
- If the participant decides to withdraw before moving to Stage 2:



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- The \$150 fee associated with Stage 1 will be non-refundable.
- The remaining amount paid (50% or 100% of the total) will be refunded in full.

Advance Payments at Stage 2:

- Participants who pay 50% or 100% of the program cost at Stage 2 and subsequently withdraw:
- A partial refund of the Stage 2 fee may be issued, depending on whether the participant has been approved by the sponsor.
- 100% of the fees associated with Stage 3 and Stage 4 will be refunded.

Advance Payments at Stage 3:

- Participants who pay 50% or 100% of the program cost at Stage 3 and later withdraw:
- No refund will be issued for services already rendered in Stage 3.
- 100% of the fees associated with Stage 4 will be refunded.

General Refund Policy for Unreached Stages:

- Any payments made for stages not yet initiated will be refunded in full if the participant chooses to withdraw.
- Refunds will be processed within 30 days of receiving a formal written request from the participant.

Procedures for the Withdrawal:

- Participants must submit a formal letter stating their decision to withdraw.
- Refunds will be calculated and communicated in writing, specifying amounts retained for services already rendered and amounts eligible for a refund.
- This policy ensures flexibility for participants while maintaining transparency in refund and payment terms.

Acknowledgments and Definitions



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To ensure mutual understanding and a smooth experience throughout the Cultural Exchange Program, we provide the following definitions and additional information:

Definitions

1. **Participant:** An individual who applies for and is accepted into the Cultural Exchange Program facilitated by CTI Group. Participants are responsible for cooperating with CTI Group, the Sponsor, and the Hosting Company throughout all stages of the program.
2. **Sponsor:** An organization authorized by the U.S. Department of State to administer J-1 Visa programs. The Sponsor is responsible for issuing the necessary documents for the visa application, providing orientation, and ensuring compliance with program regulations and policies.
3. **Hosting Company:** The U.S.-based organization or employer where the participant will engage in their cultural exchange experience. The Hosting Company provides training, supervision, and support to the participants during their stay in the USA.

Additional Information

- **Communication:** Open and timely communication between the Participant, CTI Group, the Sponsor, and the Hosting Company is crucial for the success of the program. Participants are expected to respond promptly to communications and provide accurate information when requested.
- **Compliance with Laws and Regulations:** Participants must adhere to all U.S. laws and regulations, as well as the policies of the Sponsor and Hosting Company. Non-compliance may result in termination from the program and potential legal consequences.
- **Cultural Sensitivity and Adaptation:** Participants are encouraged to embrace cultural differences and demonstrate respect and professionalism in all interactions. This will enhance the cultural exchange experience and promote positive relationships.



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- **Support and Resources:** CTI Group is committed to supporting participants throughout the program. Should any issues or concerns arise, participants are encouraged to reach out to CTI Group for assistance.
- **Financial Responsibilities:** Participants are responsible for understanding all fees associated with each stage of the program and ensuring timely payments. This includes fees for CTI Group services, Sponsor, visa processing, SEVIS, airfare, accommodation, and personal expenses. Please note that applicable transfer fees may apply when payments are made.
- **Refund Policies:** Participants should review the refund policies outlined in each stage carefully. Understanding the conditions under which refunds are or are not provided will help manage expectations and financial planning. The refund process may take up to 30 days to complete.
- **Program Timeline:** Adhering to the timelines specified in each stage is essential. Delays can affect not only your placement but also CTI Group's relationship with Sponsors and Hosting Companies.
- **Legal Obligations:** Participants must not overstay their visa in the USA. Doing so can have serious legal repercussions and negatively impact future travel or visa applications.

REFUND POLICY SUMMARY						
Scenario	Stage 1 (\$150)	Stage 2 (\$1,450)	Stage 3 (\$2,493)	Stage 4 Intern OTC (\$657)	Stage 4 General Intern (\$857)	Stage 4 General Trainee (\$1,132)
Cancellation Before Receiving an Offer Letter (if already added to the sponsor portal, documents completed, and currently going through the application process)	Non- Refundable	Non- Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable
Cancellation After Receiving Offer Letter	Non- Refundable	Non- Refundable	Non-refundable: \$1,000 (program cancellation fee)	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable



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(even if participant reject the offer)						
Cancellation After Receiving Offer Letter, Before Receiving DS Forms	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-refundable: \$1,000 (program cancelation fee)	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable
Cancellation After Receiving DS Forms	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-refundable: \$1,000 (program cancelation fee), \$350 (standard cancelation fee), \$220 (SEVIS fee)	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable
Cancellation Due to Visa Rejection (1 rejection)	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-refundable: \$500 (program cancelation fee), \$185 (embassy visa), \$50 (visa fee), \$220 (SEVIS fee)	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable
Cancellation Due to Visa Rejection (minimum of 2 rejections)	Non-Refundable	Fully Refundable	Non-refundable: \$500 (program cancelation fee), \$185 (embassy visa), \$50 (visa fee), \$220 (SEVIS fee), \$250 (payment transaction fee)	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable	Fully Refundable
Cancellation After Visa is Approved	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable	Non-Refundable

Final Acknowledgment

Please type your name below and sign

I _____

☐ By participating in this Cultural Exchange Program, you acknowledge that you have read, understood, and agreed to all the policies and procedures outlined in this document. Your



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commitment to these guidelines is essential for a successful and rewarding experience for all parties involved.

Signature

We appreciate your cooperation and look forward to supporting you throughout your cultural exchange journey. Together, we can ensure a smooth process and a valuable experience that promotes cultural understanding and personal growth.